

science is never finished and that their work might be superseded. In 1590, a major revision occurred when Galileo Galilei disproved Aristotle's theory of falling bodies, instead asserting that objects fall at the same finite speed regardless of mass. Galileo's support for Copernicus's radical idea of a heliocentric universe, where the Earth rotates around the Sun, led to Galileo being declared a heretic, but it also paved the way for the modern understanding of the Universe.

Science comes of age

During the 17th century, Isaac Newton precipitated the scientific revolution of the early modern period with his laws of motion and law of universal gravitation, which fundamentally changed the way that humans understood the world. Progress gathered pace during the 18th century in diverse fields, such as geology, with James Hutton's theory of the ancient age of the Earth, and chemistry, with John Dalton's discovery of the nature of atoms. Alessandro Volta's electric battery immediately benefited society and provided a new tool for scientists. Michael Faraday's study of electromagnetism led to the invention of the electric motor, a utilitarian and epoch-making device.

In search of truth

Science increasingly changed the course of everyday life through the 20th century. Alexander Fleming's discovery of penicillin in 1928 saved at least 200 million lives

“The important thing is **not to stop questioning.**”

Albert Einstein, 1955

during World War II, while Marie Curie's work in the field of radioactivity has had a lasting impact on medical and scientific research. Meanwhile, Albert Einstein's theories of relativity rewrote the rules of classical physics and introduced entirely new concepts to the study of the nature and origins of the Universe.

Advances, such as even more powerful computers, as conceived by Alan Turing, and better connected ones, realized by Tim Berners-Lee's World Wide Web, have enabled scientists to move faster and further in the pursuit of knowledge. Frederick Sanger unraveled the chemical sequence of DNA, while Stephen Hawking used relativity and quantum theory to predict the physics of black holes.

From the makeup of our chromosomes to the deepest reaches of space-time, scientists will always strive for truth. Building on previous work and theories, they will continue to shape history and seek to answer the most essential questions about the Universe.